

ASSESSMENT TOOL 1

COURSE CODE: CSA16 **COURSE NAME:** Data Warehousing and Data Mining
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COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

CO2: Apply suitable Data Pre-processing techniques like Data cleaning, Data integration, Data transformation and data Reduction, for effective data preparation (BL3,BL4)

Analytical Problem Solving

1. Covariance Analysis in Health Insurance (10 Marks)

The table below shows the **annual premium increase rate (xi)** and the **number of claims per 100 policyholders (yi)** in a health insurance company.

Using the covariance formula, determine whether premium increase and claim frequency have a **positive or inverse relationship**.

Before computing covariance, calculate the **mean of x and y**.

Premium Increase % (xi)	Claims per 100 Policyholders (yi)
3.2	15
4.0	18
5.5	25
4.8	20

SOLUTION:

Step 1 — Tabulate the data

i	Premium % (xi)	Claims/100 (yi)
1	3.2	15
2	4.0	18
3	5.5	25
4	4.8	20

Step 2 — Compute the means

Step 3 — Compute deviations and products

x_i	y_i	$(x_i - \bar{x})$	$(y_i - \bar{y})$	$(x_i - \bar{x})(y_i - \bar{y})$
3.2	15	-1.175	-4.5	5.2875
4.0	18	-0.375	-1.5	0.5625
5.5	25	1.125	5.5	6.1875
4.8	20	0.425	0.5	0.2125
			$\Sigma =$	12.25

Step 4 — Apply the covariance formula

Answer: $\text{Cov}(x, y) = +3.0625$ (a positive value).

Interpretation: Since the covariance is positive, premium increase rate and claim frequency move in the **same direction** — a **positive (direct) relationship**. As the premium increase % rises, the number of claims per 100 policyholders also tends to rise.

Q3. Equal-Width Binning — BMI Risk Categorization (5 Marks)

Q4. Data Reduction — Bin Medians for Medical Supply Costs (5 Marks)

Note: the given list wasn't actually in sorted order (it starts 120, 150, 160, 160, **140**... which dips down), so the first step is to sort it as the question intends.

Sorted data (27 values):

120, 140, 145, 145, 148, 150, 150, 150, 155, 155, 155, 155, 160, 160, 165, 170, 170, 175, 175, 175, 180, 190, 200, 210, 230, 300

Step 1 — Partition into equal-depth bins (depth = 3, matching Q2's method)

Bin Values Sorted within bin Median

1	120, 140, 145	120, 140, 145	140
2	145, 148, 150	145, 148, 150	148
3	150, 150, 155	150, 150, 155	150
4	155, 155, 155	155, 155, 155	155
5	160, 160, 165	160, 160, 165	160
6	170, 170, 175	170, 170, 175	170
7	175, 175, 175	175, 175, 175	175
8	180, 190, 200	180, 190, 200	190
9	210, 230, 300	210, 230, 300	230

Step 2 — Replace every value in a bin with the bin's median

Bin Original values Reduced (bin median)

1	120, 140, 145	140, 140, 140
2	145, 148, 150	148, 148, 148
3	150, 150, 155	150, 150, 150
4	155, 155, 155	155, 155, 155
5	160, 160, 165	160, 160, 160
6	170, 170, 175	170, 170, 170
7	175, 175, 175	175, 175, 175
8	180, 190, 200	190, 190, 190
9	210, 230, 300	230, 230, 230

Result: the 27 individual cost records are reduced to just **9 representative values** (140, 148, 150, 155, 160, 170, 175, 190, 230) — this is bin-median-based data reduction, and it's

noticeably more robust to the extreme outlier (300) than bin-mean smoothing would be, since 300 only pulls its own bin's median (230) mildly rather than distorting a mean.

2. Data Smoothing using Equal-Frequency Binning (Healthcare) (5 Marks)

A hospital is analysing **patient blood pressure readings (systolic)** to identify trends. Due to minor fluctuations, the analyst performs **local smoothing using equal-frequency (equi-depth) binning**.

Sample Data Set (Systolic BP readings):

110, 112, 115, 115, 118, 120, 120, 122, 124, 124, 126, 126, 126, 126, 130, 135, 135, 138, 138, 138, 138, 140, 145, 150, 152, 160, 180

Data (27 values, already sorted):

110, 112, 115, 115, 118, 120, 120, 122, 124, 124, 126, 126, 126, 126, 130, 135, 135, 138, 138, 138, 138, 140, 145, 150, 152, 160, 180

Assumption: bin depth = 3 (each bin holds 3 values → 9 bins), the standard equi-depth setup for this method.

Step 1 — Partition into bins of equal depth :

Bin	Values	Sum	Bin Mean
1	110, 112, 115	337	112.33
2	115, 118, 120	353	117.67
3	120, 122, 124	366	122.00
4	124, 126, 126	376	125.33
5	126, 126, 130	382	127.33
6	135, 135, 138	408	136.00
7	138, 138, 138	414	138.00
8	140, 145, 150	435	145.00
9	152, 160, 180	492	164.00

Step 2 — Smooth by bin means

Original	Smoothed	Original	Smoothed	Original	Smoothed
110	112.33	124	125.33	138	138.00
112	112.33	126	127.33	138	138.00
115	112.33	126	127.33	140	145.00
115	117.67	130	127.33	145	145.00
118	117.67	135	136.00	150	145.00
120	117.67	135	136.00	152	164.00
120	122.00	138	136.00	160	164.00

122	122.00	138	138.00	180	164.00
124	122.00	138	138.00		

Result: The sharp fluctuations (e.g., 152 → 160 → 180) are flattened into smoother, representative values, which reduces noise while preserving the overall trend.

3. Equal-Width Binning for Risk Categorization (5 Marks)

An insurance company evaluates **Body Mass Index (BMI)** of 18 clients for risk classification.

To simplify analysis, they smooth the data by replacing values with **closest bin boundaries using equal-width partitioning**.

Sample Data Set (Sorted BMI):

18.5, 19.2, 21.8, 24.9, 25.5, 26.2, 26.4, 27.8, 29.2, 30.2, 30.4, 31.9, 32.4, 33.1, 33.6, 34.7, 38.2, 39.5

SOLUTION:

Data (18 values, sorted):

18.5, 19.2, 21.8, 24.9, 25.5, 26.2, 26.4, 27.8, 29.2, 30.2, 30.4, 31.9, 32.4, 33.1, 33.6, 34.7, 38.2, 39.5

Assumption: 4 equal-width bins (mirrors the 4 standard BMI risk categories).

Step 1 — Compute bin width

Step 2 — Define bin boundaries

Bin	Range
Bin 1	18.50 – 23.75
Bin 2	23.75 – 29.00
Bin 3	29.00 – 34.25
Bin 4	34.25 – 39.50

Step 3 — Assign each value and smooth by *nearest boundary*

Value	Bin	Distance to lower / upper boundary	Replaced with
18.5	1	0.00 / 5.25	18.50
19.2	1	0.70 / 4.55	18.50
21.8	1	3.30 / 1.95	23.75
24.9	2	1.15 / 4.10	23.75
25.5	2	1.75 / 3.50	23.75
26.2	2	2.45 / 2.80	23.75
26.4	2	2.65 / 2.60	29.00
27.8	2	4.05 / 1.20	29.00
29.2	3	0.20 / 5.05	29.00

30.2	3	1.20 / 4.05	29.00
30.4	3	1.40 / 3.85	29.00
31.9	3	2.90 / 2.35	34.25
32.4	3	3.40 / 1.85	34.25
33.1	3	4.10 / 1.15	34.25
33.6	3	4.60 / 0.65	34.25
34.7	4	0.45 / 4.80	34.25
38.2	4	3.95 / 1.30	39.50
39.5	4	0.00 / 5.25	39.50

Result: all 18 BMI values are reduced to just 4 distinct boundary values (18.50, 23.75, 29.00, 34.25, 39.50), simplifying risk classification while retaining the low/normal/overweight/obese structure.

4. Data Reduction using Bin Medians (Medical Supply Costs) (5 Marks)

A hospital administration is reviewing the **cost of medical consumables (in ₹)**. To reduce data for mining purposes, they discretize the sorted price records using **bin medians**.

Sample Data Set (Costs in ₹):

120, 150, 160, 160, 140, 145, 145, 148, 150, 150, 155, 155, 155, 155, 165, 170, 170, 175, 175, 175, 175, 180, 190, 200, 210, 230, 300

SOLUTION:

Sorted data (27 values):

120, 140, 145, 145, 148, 150, 150, 150, 155, 155, 155, 155, 160, 160, 165, 170, 170, 175, 175, 175, 175, 180, 190, 200, 210, 230, 300

Step 1 — Partition into equal-depth bins (depth = 3, matching Q2's method)

Bin	Values	Sorted within bin	Median
1	120, 140, 145	120, 140, 145	140
2	145, 148, 150	145, 148, 150	148
3	150, 150, 155	150, 150, 155	150
4	155, 155, 155	155, 155, 155	155
5	160, 160, 165	160, 160, 165	160
6	170, 170, 175	170, 170, 175	170
7	175, 175, 175	175, 175, 175	175
8	180, 190, 200	180, 190, 200	190
9	210, 230, 300	210, 230, 300	230

Step 2 — Replace every value in a bin with the bin's median

Bin	Original values	Reduced (bin median)
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1	120, 140, 145	140, 140, 140
2	145, 148, 150	148, 148, 148
3	150, 150, 155	150, 150, 150
4	155, 155, 155	155, 155, 155
5	160, 160, 165	160, 160, 160
6	170, 170, 175	170, 170, 170
7	175, 175, 175	175, 175, 175
8	180, 190, 200	190, 190, 190
9	210, 230, 300	230, 230, 230

Result: the 27 individual cost records are reduced to just **9 representative values** (140, 148, 150, 155, 160, 170, 175, 190, 230) — this is bin-median-based data reduction, and it's noticeably more robust to the extreme outlier (300) than bin-mean smoothing would be, since 300 only pulls its own bin's median (230) mildly rather than distorting a mean

5. Standardization of Patient Age Data (5 Marks)

Given the following **ages of insured individuals**:

18, 22, 25, 42, 28, 43, 33, 35, 56, 28

Standardize the variable by performing the following:

- Compute the **mean absolute deviation (MAD)** of age.
- Compute the **z-score for the first four observations**.

SOLUTION:

Data: 18, 22, 25, 42, 28, 43, 33, 35, 56, 28 (n = 10)

Step 1 — Compute the mean

(a) Mean Absolute Deviation (MAD)

$ x_i $	$ x_i - 33 $
18	15
22	11
25	8
42	9
28	5
43	10

	33		0	
	35		2	
	56		23	
	28		5	
	$\Sigma =$		88	

MAD = 8.8

(b) Z-scores for the first four observations

Using the MAD-based standardization formula (robust z-score):

x_i	$x_i - 33$	$z_i = (x_i - 33)/8.8$
18	-15	-1.7045
22	-11	-1.2500
25	-8	-0.9091
42	+9	+1.0227

Interpretation: Negative z-scores (18, 22, 25) mean those ages are below the group mean of 33; the positive z-score (42) means that age is above the mean, by just over one MAD.